SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

19 July 2022 · Shift 2

64 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 36 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Glad

(A) Cheery
(B) Delighted
(C) Gloomy
(D) Joyous

Q.2

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The novels of Jane Austen “give us a” a glimpse into the world of women.

(A) gave them the
(B) given us a
(C) gives us a
(D) No improvement required

Q.3

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. Caramel is made from several thousand compounds, making it one of the much complex food products.

(A) Caramel is made from several
(B) No error
(C) thousand compounds, making it one of
(D) the much complex food products

Q.4

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. It were so painful / to give up / my last hope.

(A) to give up
(B) It were so painful
(C) my last hope
(D) No error

Q.5

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. Their are numerous / buildings outside our / school premises.

(A) school premises
(B) buildings outside our
(C) Their are numerous
(D) No error

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Bloom

(A) Flower
(B) Fade
(C) Drop
(D) Wither

Q.7

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Drink a mixture of wormwood oil and olive oil “to got rid of” worms.

(A) No improvement required
(B) to rid off
(C) to getting rid by
(D) to get rid of

Q.8

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A piece of cake

(A) A hidden enemy
(B) A dangerous situation
(C) A very easy task
(D) A thoughtful mind

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Drop in the bucket

(A) An extreme overreaction to something very small or insignificant
(B) To be involved in or be a part of something great or revolutionary
(C) Something small and unimportant, especially when compared with something else
(D) An alarming or unexpected announcement, especially an unpleasant one

Q.10

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A non-professional who is inept at a particular activity

(A) Expert
(B) Amateur
(C) Director
(D) Fatalist

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. “Strenuous” exercise can result in muscle pain.

(A) Irksome
(B) Impelling
(C) Aggressive
(D) Effortless

Q.12

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Relapse

(A) Warrant
(B) Improve
(C) Pine
(D) Validate

Q.13

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Having a common centre, as circles or spheres

(A) Cylindrical
(B) Concentric
(C) Elliptical
(D) Centrifugal

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Please sit down and have breakfast _____ us.

(A) with
(B) to
(C) at
(D) on

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. My most “vivid” recollection of last summer is the ocean.

(A) vague
(B) composed
(C) lucid
(D) blurry

Q.16

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Both of "mine child passed" the examination successfully.

(A) my children passed
(B) our children passes
(C) No improvement required
(D) my child pass

Q.17

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Precurser
(B) Acknowledge
(C) Religiocity
(D) Anceistors

Q.18

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who can use either hand with ease

(A) Gregarious
(B) Virtuoso
(C) Pedantic
(D) Ambidextrous

Q.20

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Bring me the finest dress "from an finest" shop.

(A) from the finest
(B) of the finer
(C) No improvement required
(D) through a finer

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Latin may be the language that we (1) _____ with the Roman Empire, but the uestion of (2) _____ the Romans spoke Latin or not (3) _____ not have a simple answer. Rome grew from a tiny community in the middle of a culturally diverse peninsula into an empire that reached (4) _____ Britain to Syria. As Rome's power spread, Romans also interacted with (5) _____ of dozens of other languages

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) delink
(B) remind
(C) associate
(D) imply

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Latin may be the language that we (1) _____ with the Roman Empire, but the uestion of (2) _____ the Romans spoke Latin or not (3) _____ not have a simple answer. Rome grew from a tiny community in the middle of a culturally diverse peninsula into an empire that reached (4) _____ Britain to Syria. As Rome's power spread, Romans also interacted with (5) _____ of dozens of other languages

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) whether
(B) did
(C) do
(D) either

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Latin may be the language that we (1) _____ with the Roman Empire, but the uestion of (2) _____ the Romans spoke Latin or not (3) _____ not have a simple answer. Rome grew from a tiny community in the middle of a culturally diverse peninsula into an empire that reached (4) _____ Britain to Syria. As Rome's power spread, Romans also interacted with (5) _____ of dozens of other languages

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) do
(B) should
(C) does
(D) done

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Latin may be the language that we (1) _____ with the Roman Empire, but the uestion of (2) _____ the Romans spoke Latin or not (3) _____ not have a simple answer. Rome grew from a tiny community in the middle of a culturally diverse peninsula into an empire that reached (4) _____ Britain to Syria. As Rome's power spread, Romans also interacted with (5) _____ of dozens of other languages

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) both
(B) of
(C) between
(D) from

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Latin may be the language that we (1) _____ with the Roman Empire, but the uestion of (2) _____ the Romans spoke Latin or not (3) _____ not have a simple answer. Rome grew from a tiny community in the middle of a culturally diverse peninsula into an empire that reached (4) _____ Britain to Syria. As Rome's power spread, Romans also interacted with (5) _____ of dozens of other languages

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) capitals
(B) speakers
(C) principals
(D) sleepers

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Select the option that is related to the fourth number in the same way as the first number is related to the second number and the fifth number is related to the sixth number. 7: 42 :: ? : 110 :: 9 : 72

(A) 8
(B) 6
(C) 12
(D) 11

Q.2

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (16, 4, 8); (12, 2, 12)

(A) (20, 2, 8)
(B) (18, 8, 3)
(C) (28, 7, 8)
(D) (32, 3, 10)

Q.3

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. GOOD : CKKZ :: BEST : XAOP :: COOL : ?

(A) YJJH
(B) WKKH
(C) YKKI
(D) YKKH

Q.5

In a certain code language, ‘Homonym is antonym’ is coded as ‘# kr pg’, and ‘Antonym are synonym’ is coded as ‘lm pg 6’. What is the code for ‘Antonym’ in that language?

(A) #
(B) kr
(C) lm
(D) pg

Q.6

Select the letter from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. D, F, I, ?, R, X

(A) O
(B) M
(C) L
(D) N

Q.7

Among seven sisters Anu, Barsha, Champa, Disha, Emma, Farheen and Geeta; Barsha is elder than only four other sisters. Champa is elder than Disha. Anu is elder than Farheen. Emma is elder than one person only, that is Geeta, who is the youngest among all sisters. Barsha is elder than Anu. Given that no two sisters have the same age, find out who is the eldest sister.

(A) Champa
(B) Disha
(C) Farheen
(D) Anu

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. RO : WJ :: PJ : ?

(A) UF
(B) VF
(C) VE
(D) UE

Q.9

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 425, 442, 459, 476, ?

(A) 482
(B) 503
(C) 493
(D) 498

Q.13

In a certain code language, 'ROMKSG' is written as 'SQPJQD', and 'PNDABC' is written as 'QPGZZZ'. How will 'QJLMTF' be written in that language?

(A) RLOLSC
(B) RLLORC
(C) RLLOSC
(D) RLOLRC

Q.14

Four boys A, R, K and M are sitting in a row facing the North (but not necessarily in the same order) and four girls P, Q, L and B are sitting in a row facing these boys (but not necessarily in the same order). B is second to the right of P. K and A are at the ends. P is at one of the ends. K is at the left end of the row. One boy is sitting between A and R. If Q is at one of the ends, then who is L facing?

(A) K
(B) M
(C) A
(D) R

Q.15

What will come in the place of ‘?’ in the following equation, if ‘+’ and ‘ – ‘ are interchanged and also ‘×’ and ‘÷’ are interchanged? 42 + 10 × 5 – 9 ÷ 1 = ?

(A) 38
(B) 49
(C) 44
(D) 31

Q.17

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statement I: All black are green and no green is red. Statement II: All red are pink. Conclusion I:All black are pink. Conclusion II: Some green are pink.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follow.
(C) Only conclusion I follows.
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Q.18

In a certain code language, '524' means 'are you fine', '785' means 'you come home' and '6271' means 'we are at home'. What is the code for 'come home' in the same language?

(A) 28
(B) 91
(C) 87
(D) 54

Q.19

In a certain code language, 'WORLD' is written as 'CUXRJ' and 'SMOKE' is written as 'YSUQK'. How will 'INDIA' be written in that language?

(A) OSJOG
(B) OTKOG
(C) OTJOG
(D) OTJOH

Q.20

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statement I: All leopards are cheetahs. Statement II: No cheetah is a cat. Conclusion I: Some cats are leopards. Conclusion II: Some cats are cheetahs.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(C) Only conclusion I follows.
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Q.22

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '+' and '×' are interchanged and also '–' and '÷' are interchanged? $42 + 6 - 3 \times 15 \div 5 = ?$

(A) 94
(B) 85
(C) 63
(D) 74

Q.23

Seven people Pravin, Rahul, Shikhar, Tirtha, Uday, Vinay, and Wasim are sitting in a straight row facing North. Rahul is sitting second left to Tirtha. Tirtha is sitting third left to Wasim. Rahul and Shikhar are not sitting at either of the corners. Uday is the immediate neighbour of Vinay. Vinay is sitting second left from the right corner. Who is sitting to the immediate left of Rahul?

(A) Uday
(B) Tirtha
(C) Vinay
(D) Pravin

Q.24

Select the number from the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 13, 17, 19, 23, 29, ?

(A) 53
(B) 37
(C) 31
(D) 43

Q.25

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. ACID : IDAC :: CAMP : MPCA :: TRAY : ?

(A) AYRT
(B) YRTA
(C) ARTY
(D) AYTR

General Awareness 21 questions

Q.1

What is a common term used to measure poverty based on the income or consumption levels?

(A) Vulnerability
(B) Social exclusion
(C) Poverty line
(D) Poverty estimates

Q.2

In which of the following states is the Panna National Park located?

(A) Odisha
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Meghalaya

Q.3

As announced in the Union Budget of FY 2022, how many pilot projects are to be set up for coal gasification?

(A) 4
(B) 8
(C) 2
(D) 6

Q.4

Which of the following pairs of autobiography and its author is INCORRECT?

(A) Unbreakable - Mary Kom
(B) The Test of My Life - Kapil Dev
(C) Playing It My Way - Sachin Tendulkar
(D) Ace Against Odds - Sania Mirza

Q.5

India won eight Olympic gold medals in which sport till 2020?

(A) Boxing
(B) 10m air rifle
(C) Wrestling
(D) Field hockey

Q.6

Who launched the International Air Connectivity Scheme (IACS) in 2022?

(A) Sachin Pilot
(B) Jyotiraditya Scindia
(C) Amit Shah
(D) Suresh Prabhu

Q.7

The Moatsu Festival is a time of great rejoicing as the planting season comes to an end. It is celebrated by the Ao tribes of _____.

(A) Manipal
(B) Meghalaya
(C) Arunachal Pradesh
(D) Nagaland

Q.9

No person can disrespect the National flag, Constitution of India and the National Anthem under the _____ Act.

(A) Factoring Regulation
(B) Armed Forces Tribunal
(C) Prevention of Insults to National Honour
(D) Whistle Blowers Protection

Q.10
In which year did Mahatma Gandhi lead the Champaran movement against the indigo planters?

(A) 1915
(B) 1918
(C) 1917
(D) 1916

Q.11
Rukmini Devi Arundale was associated with which classical dance of India?

(A) Sattriya
(B) Kathak
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Kuchipudi

Q.12
The number of deaths per thousand persons in a year is known as _____.

(A) gross reproduction rate
(B) crude rate
(C) birth rate
(D) death rate

Q.13
A traditional basketball team has 12 players, with _____ basketball players on the court at any given time.

(A) 7
(B) 4
(C) 6
(D) 5

Q.14
Which state is the leading producer of cotton in India, as of April 2022?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Telangana
(C) Karnataka
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.15
Which of the following statements is correct about endoplasmic reticulum? I. It is a large network of membrane-bound tubes and sheets. II. It is similar in structure to the plasma membrane.

(A) Only I
(B) Only II
(C) Neither I nor II
(D) Both I and II

Q.16
_____ was the capital of the Pandya dynasty.

(A) Madurai
(B) Karur
(C) Uraiyur
(D) Delhi

Q.17
Brihadeshwara temple at Thanjavur is one of the largest temples in India and is an example of Dravidian architecture during the _____ period.

(A) Chera
(B) Chola
(C) Hoysala
(D) Pandya

Q.18
Who among the following Gupta rulers is known as the 'Napoleon of India'?

(A) Vishnugupta
(B) Skandagupta
(C) Samudragupta
(D) Chandragupta I

Q.19
Who among the following was the first Indian to be selected to the British 'House of Commons' on a Liberal Party ticket?

(A) Chandra Shekhar Azad
(B) Dadabhai Naoroji
(C) Bhimrao Ramji Ambedkar
(D) Bhagat Singh

Q.20

The largest ocean on Earth is _____.

(A) Arctic Ocean
(B) Pacific Ocean
(C) Atlantic Ocean
(D) Indian Ocean

Q.21

To become a member of Rajya Sabha, a person should be a citizen of India and at least _____ of age.

(A) 30 years
(B) 35 years
(C) 28 years
(D) 32 years

Q.22

His compositions for blockbusters such as Silsila and Chandni are a manifestation of his musical brilliance. Who is he?

(A) Ustad Bismillah Khan
(B) Pandit Shivkumar Sharma
(C) Ustad Zakir Hussain
(D) Jagjit Singh

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**
Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**			

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (C) Gloomy

'Glad' means happy; its opposite is 'gloomy', sad and low in spirits. 'Cheery', 'delighted' and 'joyous' are near synonyms.

Q.2 · Answer (D) No improvement required

The plural subject 'the novels' takes the plural verb 'give', and the present tense suits a general truth, so the underlined part needs no change. (The sheet prints the article twice, 'a a glimpse'.)

Q.3 · Answer (D) the much complex food products

'One of the' needs a superlative, and 'complex' forms it with 'most', not 'much': 'one of the most complex food products'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) It were so painful

'It' is singular and takes 'was', not 'were': 'It was so painful to give up my last hope.'

Q.5 · Answer (C) Their are numerous

'There are' says that something exists; 'their' is the possessive: 'There are numerous buildings outside our school premises.'

Q.6 · Answer (A) Flower

A 'bloom' is a flower, and to bloom is to flower. 'Fade', 'drop' and 'wither' describe the end of blooming.

Q.7 · Answer (D) to get rid of

The infinitive takes the base form of the verb: 'to get rid of worms'. 'To got' is not grammatical.

Q.8 · Answer (C) A very easy task

'A piece of cake' is something very easy to do.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Something small and unimportant, especially when compared with something else

A 'drop in the bucket' is an amount too small to make much difference beside what is needed.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Amateur

An amateur does something without being paid for it, and the word is also used of someone who lacks skill at it. An expert is the opposite, and a fatalist believes events are fixed by fate.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Effortless

'Strenuous' means needing great effort; its opposite is 'effortless'. 'Irksome' means annoying and 'impelling' driving forward.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Improve

To 'relapse' is to fall back into illness or a worse state after getting better; its opposite is to 'improve'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Concentric

Concentric circles or spheres share the same centre. Elliptical means oval, and centrifugal means moving away from a centre.

Q.14 · Answer (A) with

One has a meal 'with' someone, in their company: 'have breakfast with us'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) lucid

A 'vivid' memory is clear and sharp: 'lucid' (clear). 'Vague' and 'blurry' are nearly opposite, and 'composed' means calm.

Q.16 · Answer (A) my children passed

'Both' needs a plural noun, and before a noun the possessive is 'my', not 'mine': 'Both of my children passed the examination successfully.'

Q.17 · Answer (B) Acknowledge
'Acknowledge' is spelt correctly. The others should be 'precursor', 'religiosity' and 'ancestors'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Ambidextrous
An ambidextrous person can use the right and left hands equally well. Gregarious means sociable, a virtuoso is a highly skilled performer and pedantic means too concerned with minor rules.

Q.20 · Answer (A) from the finest
A superlative such as 'finest' takes 'the': 'from the finest shop'. 'An' goes only before a vowel sound and never before a superlative.

Q.21 · Answer (C) associate
To 'associate' one thing with another is to connect them in the mind: we link Latin with the Roman Empire.

Q.22 · Answer (A) whether
'Whether' introduces two possibilities, completed here by 'or not': 'whether the Romans spoke Latin or not'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) does
The subject is the singular 'the question', so the helping verb is 'does': 'does not have a simple answer'.

Q.24 · Answer (D) from
'From ... to' gives the extent of the empire: it reached from Britain to Syria.

Q.25 · Answer (B) speakers
Romans dealt with the 'speakers' of dozens of other languages, that is with people who spoke them.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (D) 11
Each pair is a number and that number times one less than itself: 7 × 6 = 42 and 9 × 8 = 72. As 110 = 11 × 10, the missing number is 11.

Q.2 · Answer (C) (28, 7, 8)
In each set the third number is the first divided by the second, times 2: 16 ÷ 4 × 2 = 8 and 12 ÷ 2 × 2 = 12. Likewise 28 ÷ 7 × 2 = 8.

Q.3 · Answer (D) YKKH
Each letter moves 4 places back: GOOD → CKKZ and BEST → XAOP. So COOL → YKKH.

Q.5 · Answer (D) pg
'Antonym' is the only word in both sentences and 'pg' the only code in both, so 'antonym' is coded as 'pg'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) M
As places in the alphabet the series is 4, 6, 9, ?, 18, 24, with differences +2, +3, +4, +5, +6: 9 + 4 = 13, which is M.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Champa
Barsha is elder than only four sisters, so she is third eldest; Anu, Farheen, Emma and Geeta are younger than her. That leaves Champa and Disha as the two eldest, and Champa is elder than Disha.

Q.8 · Answer (D) UE
The first letter moves 5 places forward and the second 5 places back: R → W and O → J. So P → U and J → E: UE.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 493
Each term is 17 more than the one before: 476 + 17 = 493.

Q.13 · Answer (D) RLOLRC
The first three letters move +1, +2, +3 and the last three −1, −2, −3: ROMKSG → SQPJQD and PNDABC → QPGZZZ. So QJLMTF → RLOLRC.

Q.14 · Answer (B) M
Facing north, the boys sit K, R, M, A from the left, with A at the right end and one boy, M, between R and A. The girls face south, so B second to P's right puts P at the end opposite A and B opposite R; Q takes the other end, opposite K, and L faces M.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 49
After interchanging the signs: 42 – 10 ÷ 5 + 9 × 1 = 42 – 2 + 9 = 49.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Neither conclusion I nor II follow.
All black are green and no green is red, so no black is red. Pink is only known to include every red, so black and green may or may not overlap pink: neither conclusion is certain.

Q.18 · Answer (C) 87
'You' is in the first two sentences (5), 'are' in the first and third (2) and 'home' in the second and third (7). So 'come' is 8, and 'come home' is coded with 8 and 7: 87.

Q.19 · Answer (C) OTJOG
Each letter moves 6 places forward, wrapping round after Z: WORLD → CUXRJ and SMOKE → YSUQK. So INDIA → OTJOG.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
Every leopard is a cheetah and no cheetah is a cat, so no leopard is a cat either: both conclusions are false.

Q.22 · Answer (A) 94
After interchanging the signs: 42 × 6 ÷ 3 + 15 – 5 = 84 + 15 – 5 = 94.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Pravin
Rahul sits five places left of Wasim and not at a corner, so Rahul is second, Tirtha fourth and Wasim seventh from the left. Vinay and Uday take the fifth and sixth places and Shikhar, not at a corner, the third, so Pravin sits first, immediately left of Rahul.

Q.24 · Answer (C) 31
The terms are consecutive prime numbers: the next prime after 29 is 31.

Q.25 · Answer (D) AYTR
The two halves of the word swap places: AC ID → ID AC and CA MP → MP CA. So TR AY → AY TR: AYTR.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Poverty line
The poverty line is the minimum level of income or consumption needed to meet basic needs; people below it are counted as poor.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Madhya Pradesh
Panna National Park, a tiger reserve on the Ken river, is in Madhya Pradesh.

Q.3 · Answer (A) 4
The Union Budget 2022-23, presented on 1 February 2022, announced four pilot projects for coal gasification and for turning coal into chemicals that industry needs.

Q.4 · Answer (B) The Test of My Life - Kapil Dev
'The Test of My Life' is Yuvraj Singh's autobiography, not Kapil Dev's. The other three pairs are correct.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Field hockey
India's men's hockey team won Olympic gold eight times: in 1928, 1932, 1936, 1948, 1952, 1956, 1964 and 1980.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Jyotiraditya Scindia
SSC's key gives Jyotiraditya Scindia, the Union Minister of Civil Aviation in 2022, whose ministry launched the scheme, the international arm of UDAN, under which state governments choose and support routes to foreign cities.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Nagaland
Moatsu is the festival of the Ao Nagas of Nagaland, held in early May after the sowing is done.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Prevention of Insults to National Honour
The Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971 punishes insulting the National Flag or the Constitution of India and preventing the singing of the National Anthem.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 1917
Gandhi's Champaran Satyagraha, for the indigo cultivators of Champaran in Bihar, took place in 1917; it was his first satyagraha in India.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Bharatanatyam
Rukmini Devi Arundale helped revive Bharatanatyam and founded Kalakshetra in Madras (Chennai) in 1936.

Q.12 · Answer (D) death rate
The death rate is the number of deaths per thousand people in a year; the birth rate counts live births the same way.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 5
A basketball team has five players on the court at a time; the others are substitutes.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Gujarat
Gujarat was India's largest cotton producer in the 2021-22 season, ahead of Maharashtra and Telangana.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Both I and II
The endoplasmic reticulum is a large network of membrane-bound tubes and sheets, and its membrane is similar in structure to the plasma membrane, so both statements are correct.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Madurai
Madurai was the capital of the Pandyas. Uraiyur was the capital of the early Cholas, and Karur is linked with the Cheras.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Chola
The Chola king Rajaraja I built the Brihadeshwara temple at Thanjavur, completed in about 1010 CE.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Samudragupta
The historian Vincent Smith called Samudragupta the 'Napoleon of India' for his many successful military campaigns.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Dadabhai Naoroji
Dadabhai Naoroji won Finsbury Central for the Liberal Party in 1892 and became the first Indian member of the British House of Commons.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Pacific Ocean
The Pacific is the largest and deepest ocean, covering about a third of the Earth's surface.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 30 years
Article 84 requires a member of the Rajya Sabha to be a citizen of India and at least 30 years old; for the Lok Sabha the minimum is 25.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Pandit Shivkumar Sharma
The santoor player Pandit Shivkumar Sharma and the flautist Hariprasad Chaurasia, as the duo Shiv-Hari, composed the music of 'Silsila' (1981) and 'Chandni' (1989).

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